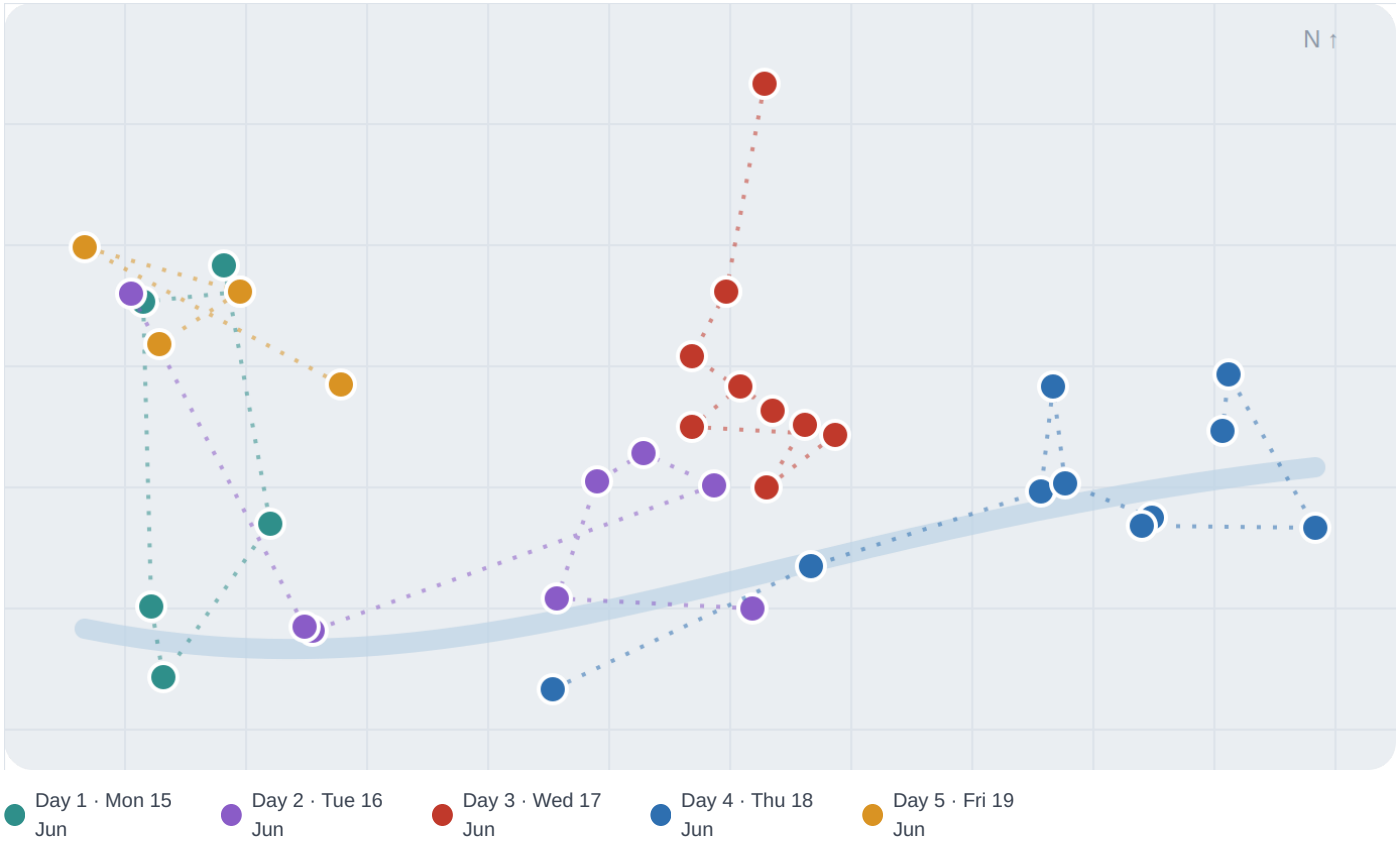


London

Itinerary, reservations & treasure hunt



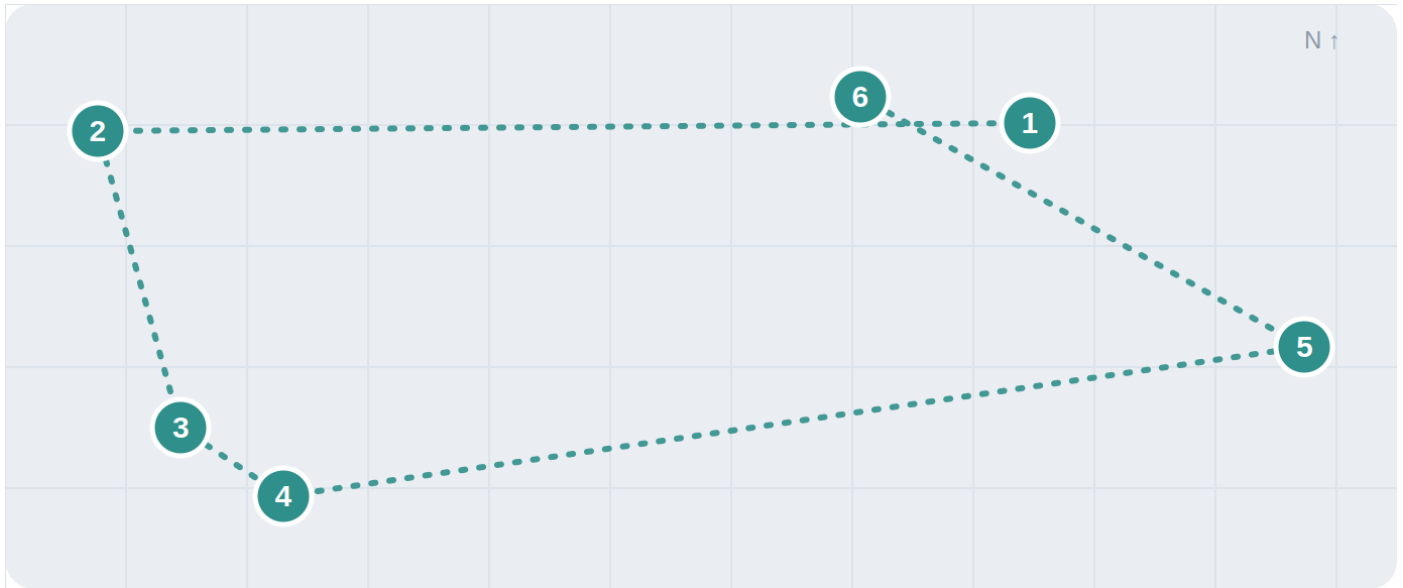
Reservations & key bookings

Mon 15 Jun · 10:40 AM	Arrive Heathrow → Heathrow Express to Paddington	Flight
Fri 19 Jun · 4:05 PM	Depart Heathrow — leave the hotel by ~12:45 PM	Flight
Mon 15 Jun · 3:30 PM	Natural History Museum — timed ticket	Booked
Tue 16 Jun · 1:00 PM	Afternoon Tea — Diamond Jubilee Tea Salon, Fortnum & Mason	Booked
Tue 16 Jun · 6:30 PM	Dinner — Ayllu Paddington	Book ahead
Wed 17 Jun · 10:50 AM	The British Museum — free timed entry	Book online
Wed 17 Jun · 1:00 PM	Lunch — British Museum (Darwin)	Booked
Wed 17 Jun · 7:30 PM	The Lion King — Lyceum Theatre	Tickets held
Thu 18 Jun · 10:00 AM	Brunch — CA Japanese Pancakes, Victoria	Book ahead
Tue 16 Jun · 5:15 PM	Paradox Museum, Knightsbridge (optional)	Book ahead
Thu 18 Jun · 4:45 PM	Horizon 22 — free viewing gallery (optional)	Book online
Thu 18 Jun · 8:30 PM	Sky Garden — free ticket or restaurant table	Book ahead
Stay · 15-19 Jun	Hilton London Metropole, 225 Edgware Rd, W2	—

Good to know:

- Heathrow Express (Paddington ↔ Heathrow) is the fastest link at ~15 min — cheaper booked ahead, and Paddington is a 10-min walk from the hotel.
- Set the kids up with contactless / Oyster for the Tube and buses.
- Book free timed slots in advance for the British Museum, the London Eye and the Sky Garden — they fill up.
- Tate Modern is free with no booking needed.
- London sunset on 18 Jun is ~9:20pm, so the 8:30 Sky Garden slot catches golden hour into dusk.

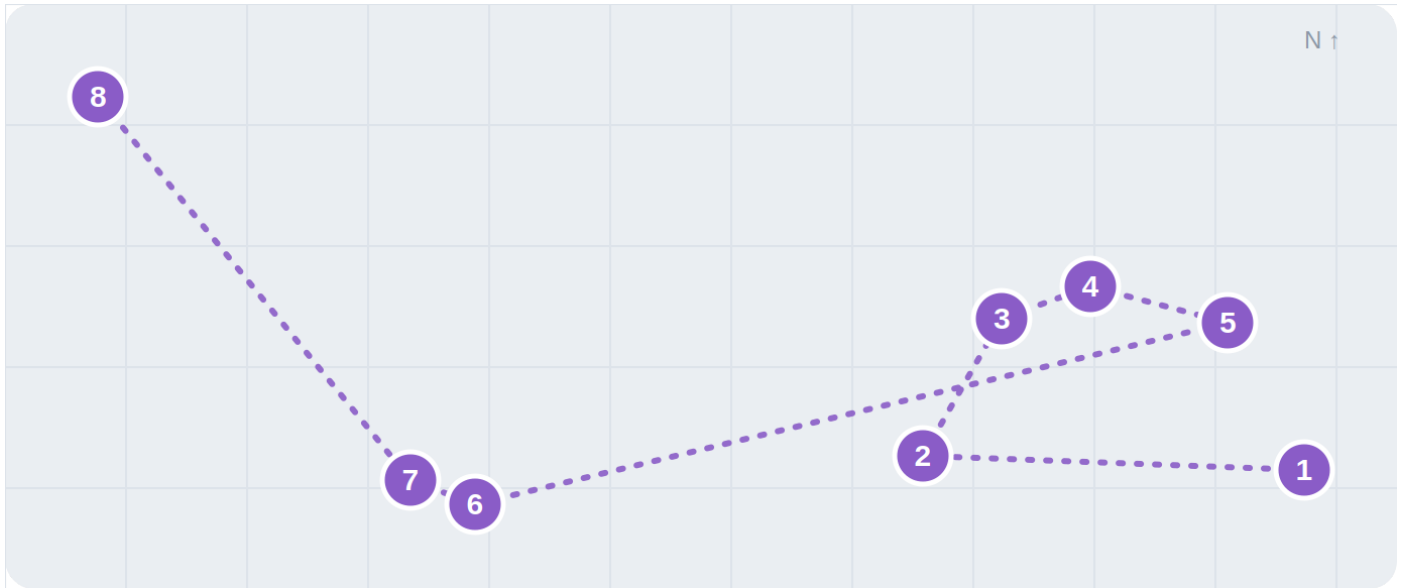
Arrival — Paddington & Hyde Park



Route overview — numbered pins match the stops listed below.

- 1** 10:40 AM · **Land at Heathrow** → **Hilton** HOTEL
 Land 10:40am; arrivals + Heathrow Express to Paddington (~15 min) puts you at the hotel around 12:45–1pm. Drop bags, then go.
- 2** 1:15 PM · **Lunch — Darcie & May Green** FOOD
 Fun first lunch on a floating canal boat in Paddington Basin / Little Venice (Aussie-style brunch & lunch, family-friendly). Bondi Green next door is a good back-up.
- 3** 3:00 PM · **Royal Albert Hall & Albert Memorial** VISIT
 Exterior photos before your museum slot — the domed hall and the gilded memorial face each other; walk down Exhibition Road to the museums.
- 4** 3:30 PM · **Natural History Museum** RESERVATION
 YOUR 3:30 TIMED TICKET. The blue whale in Hintze Hall, the roaring T. rex and the dinosaur gallery (~2 hrs to closing).
- 5** 5:30 PM · **Hyde Park stroll back** VISIT
 Wander back toward the hotel through Kensington Gardens / Hyde Park — the Serpentine, the Italian Gardens, Speakers' Corner.
- 6** 7:00 PM · **Soor Lebanese Cuisine** FOOD
 Easy arrival-night dinner on Edgware Rd, 4 min from the hotel.

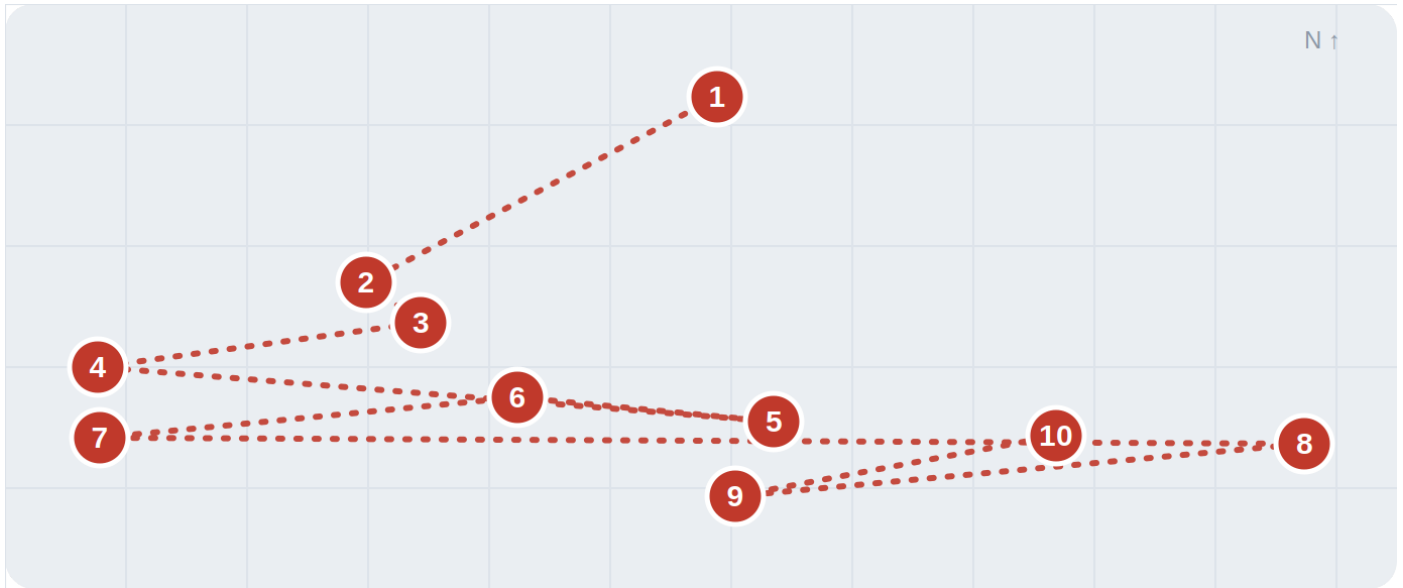
Royal London + High Tea



Route overview — numbered pins match the stops listed below.

- 1 10:30 · Big Ben & Westminster** VISIT
 Westminster Abbey, Horse Guards, the Churchill & Boudica statues, and the green Westminster Bridge are all right here.
- 2 11:45 · Buckingham Palace** VISIT
 Walk via St James's Park (pelicans + the fairytale Blue Bridge view + gold Victoria Memorial). Check the Changing of the Guard schedule.
- 3 1:00 PM · Diamond Jubilee Tea Salon** RESERVATION
 RESERVATION — afternoon tea at Fortnum & Mason, 4th floor. Catch the clock figures on the hour outside; explore the food halls after.
- 4 3:15 · Piccadilly Circus** VISIT
 The Eros statue and the giant lights. Carnaby Street and Liberty are a short walk north.
- 5 3:45 · Trafalgar Square** VISIT
 Nelson's Column & the bronze lions to climb. The National Gallery here is free — pop in for the famous paintings. Admiralty Arch leads onto The Mall.
- 6 4:30 · Harrods (optional)** OPTIONAL
 OPTIONAL — the iconic Knightsbridge department store & its famous Food Halls, on the way back west toward dinner.
- 7 5:15 · Paradox Museum (optional)** OPTIONAL
 OPTIONAL — 2 min from Harrods: a hands-on optical-illusion museum (gravity room, photo spots) the kids will love. Ticketed, book ahead; open to 7pm. (Both sit beside Day 1's Natural History Museum too, if you'd rather do them then.)
- 8 6:30 PM · Ayllu Paddington** RESERVATION
 RESERVATION — dinner back near the hotel. Entrance downstairs under the Grill Bar.

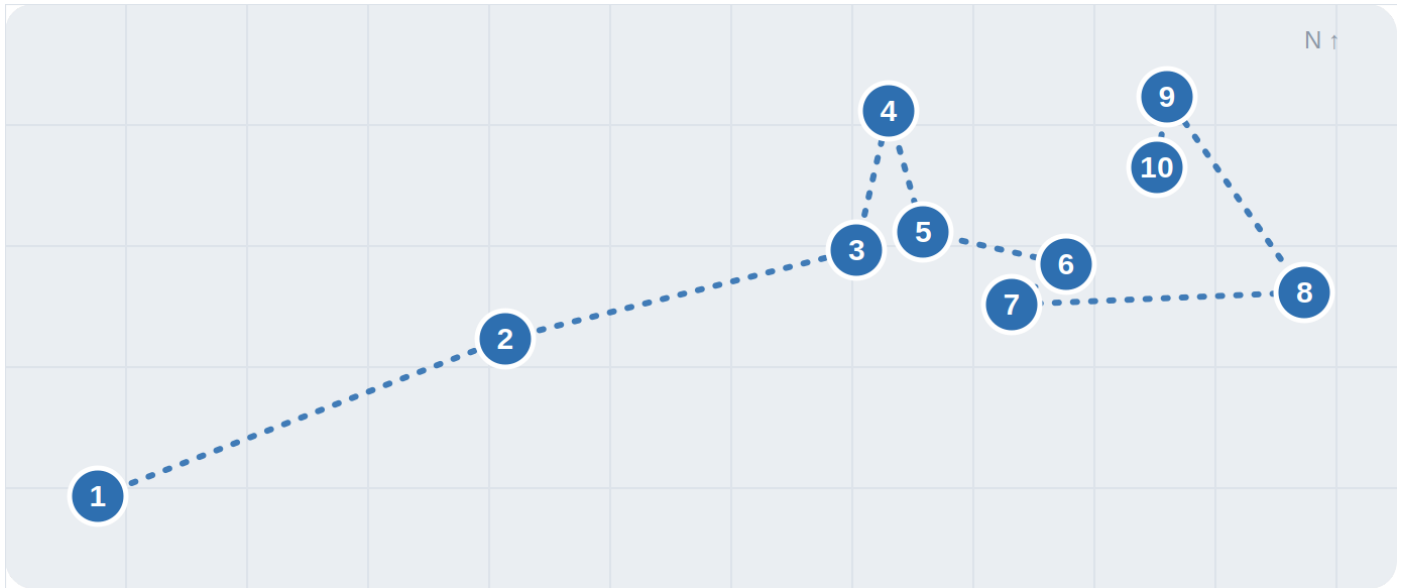
King's Cross, British Museum & The Lion King



Route overview — numbered pins match the stops listed below.

- 1** 9:15 · **King's Cross & St Pancras** VISIT
 Platform 9¾ + the Harry Potter Shop at King's Cross (go early to beat the queue); St Pancras's spectacular Victorian-Gothic frontage next door. 1 stop / short walk to the museum.
- 2** 10:50 · **The British Museum** VISIT
 RESERVATION (free slot). Rosetta Stone, Egyptian mummies, the Easter Island statue, the Great Court glass roof. Woburn Walk (a Bridgerton street) is a short walk north.
- 3** 1:00 PM · **Lunch — British Museum (Darwin)** RESERVATION
 RESERVATION — your 1pm lunch at the museum.
- 4** 2:15 · **Outernet (Now Building)** VISIT
 Free immersive hall wrapped in giant LED screens by Tottenham Court Road — open 10am–late, no booking. On the way from the museum to Covent Garden.
- 5** 2:50 · **Covent Garden & Seven Dials** VISIT
 Street performers under the Piazza, the Apple Market, the rainbow of Neal's Yard, the Seven Dials sundial and hidden Goodwin's Court.
- 6** 3:20 · **Humble Crumble (Seven Dials)** FOOD
 Your crumble stop — warm crumble + unlimited custard in the Seven Dials market hall.
- 7** 4:00 · **TSUJIRI matcha & Chinatown** FOOD
 Matcha soft-serve from a 160-year-old Kyoto tea house, by Leicester Square — where the Lego & M&M's stores are.
- 8** 5:00 · **Somerset House & the Strand** VISIT
 Courtyard fountains to run through, river-terrace views, the tiny Twinings tea shop & Cleopatra's Needle nearby. LSE (Houghton St) is a 5-min walk if you'd like to see the campus.
- 9** 6:00 PM · **Crispy Rolls / My Hiro** FOOD
 Light pre-theatre bite — 45 Villiers St near Embankment, a 6-min walk from the Lyceum.
- 10** 7:30 PM · **The Lion King — Lyceum** RESERVATION
 RESERVATION — evening show. Grab a pre-theatre bite near Covent Garden first.

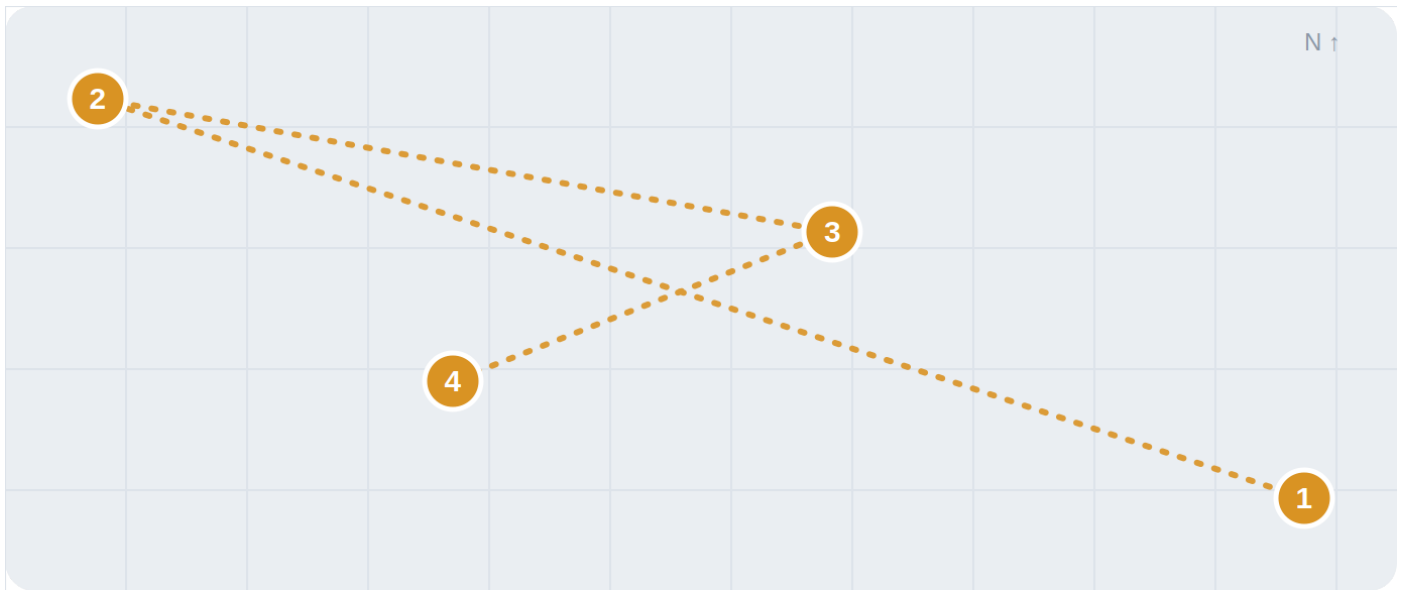
South Bank, the Eye & the River



Route overview — numbered pins match the stops listed below.

- 1** 10:00 AM · **CA Japanese Pancakes (Victoria)** **FOOD**
 Start with a soufflé-pancake brunch (gluten- & dairy-free) near Victoria — book ahead, it's small. A short hop west of the London Eye.
- 2** 11:15 · **London Eye + Thames river boat** **VISIT**
 Ride the Eye as it opens (book ahead), then catch a Thames river boat east — a restful cruise past Parliament and under the bridges to Bankside.
- 3** 12:30 · **Tate Modern** **VISIT**
 Free. Turbine Hall + the viewing level for skyline views.
- 4** 1:15 · **Millennium Bridge → St Paul's** **VISIT**
 Cross the Harry Potter 'wobbly bridge' to Wren's dome (the Mary Poppins steps), then back.
- 5** 1:50 · **Shakespeare's Globe** **VISIT**
 The round timber theatre on Bankside. Playing in June: A Midsummer Night's Dream (great for families) & Much Ado About Nothing — £5 standing / £10 tickets at shakespearesglobe.com. An evening show would replace tonight's Sky Garden; a matinee would reshape the afternoon.
- 6** 2:10 · **Southwark Cathedral** **VISIT**
 A beautiful, peaceful Gothic cathedral literally next to Borough Market (free; with Shakespeare connections) — a lovely 15-min pause before lunch.
- 7** 2:30 · **Borough Market** **FOOD**
 Lunch — Bridget Jones lived right above it. The Golden Hinde, Winchester Palace ruins & HMS Belfast are all here.
- 8** 3:45 · **Tower Bridge (from the bank)** **VISIT**
 The classic riverside photo (no Tower entry) — the Spider-Man: Far From Home backdrop. St Dunstan in the East ivy ruin is a short detour.
- 9** 4:45 · **Horizon 22 (optional)** **OPTIONAL**
 OPTIONAL — London's highest FREE viewpoint (level 58, 22 Bishopsgate); book a free slot, closes 6pm. Since you've got the Sky Garden tonight you could skip it — or swap in St Katharine Docks (pretty marina by Tower Bridge) or a tour of HMS Belfast.
- 10** 8:30 PM · **Sky Garden** **RESERVATION**
 RESERVATION — free ticket or restaurant table. The Gherkin & Leadenhall (Diagon Alley) are right by it. Sunset ~9:20pm.

By the hotel, then home



Route overview — numbered pins match the stops listed below.

- 1** 9:30 AM · **Breakfast at Feya (Marble Arch)** FOOD
A pretty, floral last breakfast at 6 Marble Arch — pancakes, waffles, the kunafa hot chocolate — a 12-min walk from the hotel. Opens 9:30; very Instagram.
- 2** 10:30 AM · **Little Venice & Paddington** VISIT
A last gentle canal stroll (boat trips run from here) and the Paddington Bear statue at the station, right by the hotel. No museum today.
- 3** 11:45 AM · **Hilton — checkout & bags** HOTEL
Collect luggage / check out.
- 4** 12:45 PM · **Leave for Heathrow** DEPART
Heathrow Express from Paddington (~15 min). For the 4:05pm flight, aim to be at the airport by ~2pm.
-  **4:05 PM · Depart Heathrow** DEPART
Flight home. Safe travels!

London Treasure Hunt

73 treasures · 1180 points. Tick each one off as you find it. Ranks: 25% Explorer · 50% Adventurer · 75% Treasure Hunter · 100% London Legend → claim the prize!

FINAL PRIZE (grown-ups fill in): _____

 **Paddington Bear statue** +10

The famous bear came from 'Darkest Peru' and arrived at this exact station — the books begin right here on the platform.

Photo: Sit next to him with his battered suitcase (Platform 1).

 **A houseboat in Little Venice** +10

A hidden canal where people actually live on long, brightly painted narrowboats. It feels nothing like a big city.

Photo: A colourful boat mirrored in the still water.

 **The Peter Pan statue** Hidden +20

Author J.M. Barrie had it placed secretly overnight in 1912 so children would think it appeared by magic.

Photo: The tiny fairies and animals climbing the base.

 **The Elfin Oak** Hidden +20

A 900-year-old tree stump carved with little elves, witches and animals hiding in the bark.

Photo: Find the smallest creature you can spot.

 **A wild green parakeet** Legendary +30

Thousands of bright-green parrots live wild in the parks — and nobody knows for sure how they got to London.

Photo: One in flight or perched (they sometimes land on an open hand).

 **The pirate ship** +10

The giant wooden galleon at the Diana Memorial Playground, built for exactly this kind of adventure.

Photo: At the ship's wheel, captain's face on.

 **The golden Albert Memorial** +10

A glittering gold monument Queen Victoria built for her husband — over the top on purpose.

Photo: The gleaming gold figure under the spire.

 **Paddington's Brunel roof** +10

The station's huge wave-like iron-and-glass roof was designed by Isambard Kingdom Brunel in 1854 — engineering built like a cathedral.

Photo: Phone up at the curved glass roof spans.

 **The Merchant Square fan bridge** Hidden +20

A hidden footbridge in Paddington Basin that lifts in five steel 'fingers' like a folding fan — catch it opening if you can.

Photo: The angled steel beams of the bridge.

 **The Italian Gardens** Hidden +20

Ornamental Victorian water gardens at the top of the Long Water — said to be a gift from Prince Albert to Queen Victoria.

Photo: The fountains and carved stone urns.

 **Royal Albert Hall** +10

The vast round red-brick concert hall from 1871 — a dome you'll recognise the instant you see it.

Photo: The whole oval building in one frame.

 **Kensington Palace gates** +10

A working royal home for 300 years — the golden gates became a sea of flowers for Princess Diana in 1997.

Photo: The ornate gold gates.

 **The pastel houses of Notting Hill** Bonus +20

The candy-coloured terraced houses around Portobello Road are one of London's most-photographed streets — and the setting of the film 'Notting Hill'. A short hop west of the hotel.

Photo: A row of pink, blue and mint houses (or the famous travel-bookshop).

 **221B Baker Street** Bonus +20

The home of Sherlock Holmes — there's a statue of the great detective outside the Tube station and the door marked 221B nearby. A short hop from the hotel.

Photo: By the Sherlock statue, or the 221B door in a deerstalker pose.

 **'Hope' the blue whale** Bonus +20

The Natural History Museum's centrepiece — a 25m blue whale skeleton diving over the grand Hintze Hall. The largest animal that has ever lived.

Photo: Standing under the whale in the great hall.

 **The roaring T. rex** Bonus +20

A life-size animatronic T. rex in the museum's dinosaur gallery that moves and roars as if it's spotted you.

Photo: With the dinosaur caught mid-roar.

**Big Ben on the hour** +10

The bell weighs 13.7 tonnes and its bongs are broadcast around the world. Time your visit to hear it.

Photo: The clock face right as it chimes.

**Boudica's war chariot** +20

A warrior queen who burned Roman London to the ground in AD 60 — now charging on a bronze chariot by the bridge.

Photo: The rearing horses, no reins.

**A mounted Horse Guard** +10

The King's official bodyguards, sitting perfectly still on horseback at Horse Guards.

Photo: Standing beside the horse (look — don't touch!).

**A pelican in St James's Park** +20

Pelicans have lived here since 1664, a gift from a Russian ambassador. They get fed in the afternoon.

Photo: One near Duck Island around 2:30pm.

**The Royal Standard flag** **Bonus** +20

If this flag is flying over Buckingham Palace, the King is actually home right now. If not, he's out.

Photo: The flagpole on the palace roof.

**The Fortnum & Mason clock** +20

Every hour, models of Mr Fortnum and Mr Mason step out and bow to each other to chimes — right above your tea.

Photo: The two figures over the shopfront on Piccadilly.

**Eros at Piccadilly Circus** +10

One of the first statues ever cast in aluminium, surrounded by the most famous lights in London.

Photo: The winged archer under the giant screens.

**Climb a Trafalgar Square lion** +10

Four huge bronze lions guard Nelson's Column — cast from the metal of melted-down enemy cannons.

Photo: Sitting up on a lion's paw.

**Westminster Abbey** +10

Every English coronation since 1066 has happened here, and many kings and queens lie buried inside this soaring Gothic church.

Photo: The twin towers of the west front.

**Westminster Bridge** +10

It's painted green to match the seats in the House of Commons at this end — Lambeth Bridge upriver is red, for the Lords.

Photo: The green ironwork with Big Ben behind.

**The Blue Bridge view** **Hidden** +20

From the little blue bridge in St James's Park you get the most fairytale view in London — the palace one way, a skyline of domes and turrets the other.

Photo: The 'castle' skyline over the lake.

**Admiralty Arch** +10

A grand triple-arched gateway joining Trafalgar Square to The Mall — there's even a tiny carved nose hidden inside one arch.

Photo: Looking through the arches down The Mall.

**London's smallest police station** **Hidden** +20

A one-person police post hidden inside a hollow stone lamp-base in the corner of Trafalgar Square.

Photo: The little round stone 'box' everyone walks straight past.

 **The Rosetta Stone** +10
The carved stone that finally cracked the code of Egyptian hieroglyphs — the same message written in three scripts at once.
Photo: Over the heads of the crowd around its case.

 **An Egyptian mummy** **Bonus** +20
Real mummies thousands of years old, wrapped and painted for the journey to the afterlife.
Photo: A decorated coffin (sarcophagus).

 **The Great Court glass roof** +10
Europe's largest covered square, under a swirling glass-and-steel roof of 3,212 panes — no two the same.
Photo: Lying back with your phone pointed straight up.

 **A Covent Garden street act** +10
Performers have entertained on this spot since 1662 — today they audition for the right to perform.
Photo: A juggler or a 'floating' act mid-trick.

 **Neal's Yard** **Hidden** +20
A secret rainbow-coloured courtyard tucked down a narrow alley in Seven Dials. Easy to walk straight past.
Photo: The clashing bright walls and flowers.

 **The Seven Dials sundial** **Hidden** +20
One pillar with six sundials where seven streets meet — the seventh dial is the column itself.
Photo: Looking straight up the pillar.

 **A crispy roll on Villiers St** **Food** +10
Your foodie mission: cheap sushi-meets-fried-chicken rolls near Embankment that went viral online.
Photo: The roll before the first bite.

 **Humble Crumble custard** **Food** +10
Warm crumble with unlimited build-your-own custard, hidden in the Seven Dials market hall.
Photo: The custard pour in action.

 **Cleopatra's Needle** **Bonus** +20
A 3,500-year-old Egyptian obelisk — older than London itself — guarded by two bronze sphinxes still scarred by a WWI bomb.
Photo: The hieroglyphics or a sphinx's face.

 **Somerset House fountains** **Bonus** +20
55 water jets shoot straight up from the courtyard floor — in summer kids dart between them.
Photo: Mid-jump in the water.

 **The Easter Island statue** **Bonus** +20
A four-tonne stone ancestor figure carved on Rapa Nui and brought to the British Museum in 1869 — towering over everyone around it.
Photo: Looking up at the giant stone face.

 **Goodwin's Court** **Hidden** +20
A tiny gas-lit alley of curved Georgian shopfronts near Covent Garden — many believe it inspired Diagon Alley.
Photo: The bow-fronted glass windows and old lamps.

 **Twinings tea shop** **Hidden** +20
London's oldest shop still on its original spot (since 1706) — a doorway so narrow you'd walk past it, on the Strand.
Photo: The slim doorway with the golden lion above it.

 **The view from Waterloo Bridge** **Bonus** +20
Londoners call it the best free view in the city — St Paul's and the City one way, Big Ben and the Eye the other.
Photo: The skyline looking both directions.

 **Platform 9¾ at King's Cross** **Bonus** +20
A luggage trolley vanishing into the wall, exactly like in Harry Potter — with a wizard shop right beside it. A short hop north of the museum.
Photo: Pushing the half-buried trolley, scarf flying.

 **Carnaby Street** +10
A pedestrian street of bright shopfronts under giant colourful decorations — the home of London fashion since the 1960s, and very Instagram.
Photo: Standing under the arch of overhead decorations.



The screens at Outernet Bonus +20

Step inside a four-storey hall wrapped in giant LED screens by Tottenham Court Road — free immersive shows, an emoji shower, and your own social posts can pop up on the walls.

Photo: Looking up, wrapped in the screens (or caught in the emoji shower).



Woburn Walk (Bridgerton) Hidden +20

One of London's best-preserved Regency streets, with curved shopfronts and tiny balconies — it pops up in Bridgerton. Tucked near the British Museum.

Photo: Down the little black-railed street like you're in the Ton.



A TSUJIRI matcha swirl Food +10

Soft-serve from a Kyoto tea house that's been making matcha since 1860 — the green swirl is half the fun. Branches in Chinatown and Camden.

Photo: The matcha soft-serve before it melts.



The Lion King at the Lyceum Legendary +30

The big one. The opening 'Circle of Life' with the animal puppets is one of theatre's all-time great moments.

Photo: Outside the theatre before the show.

- **Tower Bridge from the bank** +10

The most photographed bridge in the world — those 'medieval' towers are really steel dressed in stone (1894), and it's the backdrop of the Spider-Man: Far From Home finale.

Photo: The whole bridge from the riverside, towers and all.
- **St Dunstan in the East** Hidden +20

A church bombed in the Blitz, now a magical ruin wrapped in climbing plants — one of London's most-photographed hidden gardens.

Photo: The ivy framing the empty gothic windows.
- **HMS Belfast** Bonus +20

A real Second World War battle cruiser moored on the Thames, guns still aimed downriver.

Photo: The grey warship against the skyline.
- **The Shard** +10

Western Europe's tallest building at 310m, shaped to look like a splinter of glass.

Photo: Phone flat to a wall, looking straight up the point.
- **Borough Market (Bridget Jones)** Food +10

London's oldest food market and a film favourite — Bridget Jones lived in the flat right above it. Get the famous chocolate strawberries.

Photo: A warm chocolate strawberry, or the green market sign.
- **Winchester Palace rose window** Hidden +20

The ruined wall of a 700-year-old bishop's palace with a beautiful stone rose window, tucked in a lane behind Borough Market.

Photo: The circular window in the old ruin.
- **The Golden Hinde galleon** Bonus +20

A full-size replica of the Tudor ship Sir Francis Drake sailed all the way around the world.

Photo: The masts of the little ship in its dock.
- **Shakespeare's Globe** +10

A faithful rebuild of the open-air wooden 'O' where Shakespeare's plays were first performed 400 years ago.

Photo: The white-and-timber round theatre.
- **Tate Modern Turbine Hall** Bonus +20

A giant former power station turned free modern-art museum — the cavernous Turbine Hall holds huge installations, and the upper floors have skyline views.

Photo: The vast hall, or your favourite weird artwork.
- **The London Eye** Bonus +20

Europe's tallest cantilevered observation wheel — 135m up with all of London below. Best reached by a Thames river boat gliding past Parliament.

Photo: The whole wheel from across the river, or the view from your capsule.
- **The Millennium Bridge** Bonus +20

London's sleek 'wobbly bridge' — and the one Death Eaters rip apart in the Harry Potter films. Walk it from Tate Modern to St Paul's.

Photo: Straight down the bridge toward the dome.
- **St Paul's Cathedral dome** +10

Wren's 300-year-old dome — and the steps where Mary Poppins sang 'Feed the Birds'.

Photo: The dome framed at the end of the bridge.
- **The Gherkin** Bonus +20

The glass bullet-shaped skyscraper (really named 30 St Mary Axe) — one of the City's most famous modern buildings.

Photo: The curved glass tower from street level.
- **Sunset from the Sky Garden** Bonus +20

A free indoor jungle in the clouds atop the 'Walkie-Talkie' tower, with floor-to-ceiling windows over the whole city.

Photo: The skyline glowing at dusk (you're booked for 8:30pm).
- **The view from Horizon 22** Bonus +20

London's highest free viewpoint — the 58th floor of 22 Bishopsgate, looking down over the Gherkin, the Shard and the whole City. Book a free slot.

Photo: The City skyline far below through the glass.
- **Leadenhall Market** Legendary +30

Side-quest in the nearby City: this ornate Victorian arcade was filmed as the entrance to Diagon Alley in Harry Potter.

Photo: The painted arches and cobbles — wand optional.

 Ride a red double-decker bus +10

London's buses have been red since 1907 — the front seat on the top deck is the best free view in the city.

Photo: Front row, upper deck, road ahead.

 A red telephone box +10

The classic design is from 1924 and mostly kept now just because everyone loves it.

Photo: Standing in the doorway of one.

 A black cab +10

Drivers must memorise 25,000 streets ('The Knowledge') before they're even allowed to drive one.

Photo: Arm out, hailing one like a local.

 A Tube roundel +10

The red-circle-and-blue-bar symbol, born in 1908, is one of the most copied logos in the world.

Photo: A station roundel with the station name inside.

 One last Paddington Bear **Bonus** +20

Bring the trip full circle — back to the bear and the station where it all started.

Photo: At the Paddington statue or shop before you head to the airport.

 Marble Arch +10

A white marble triumphal arch that once stood in front of Buckingham Palace before being moved here by Hyde Park.

Photo: Standing under the central arch.

 A blue plaque **Hidden** +20

Round blue signs mark the actual buildings where famous people lived — Dickens, Hendrix, Darwin and hundreds more.

Photo: A plaque with a name you recognise.

 A hidden cobbled mews **Hidden** +20

Pretty cobbled lanes of old stables-turned-houses are tucked behind the grand streets all around your hotel.

Photo: A flower-covered mews with no cars.